CalWORKs Program Guide: A. Assistance Unit

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 44-200: ASSISTANCE UNIT COMPOSITION
TITLE: A. THE ASSISTANCE UNIT (AU) AND MANDATORY MEMBERS

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE

The Assistance Unit (AU) is the group of persons within a household who are eligible to receive CalWORKs cash assistance together. This section details mandatory AU inclusion rules, optional member choices, excluded individuals, and the relationship between the AU and the Family Budget Unit (FBU) under CDSS MPP EAS 44-205.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & AU COMPOSITION

? Mandatory Inclusion Rules: The following individuals living in the same home must be included in the AU if eligible:
(1) The eligible child(ren);
(2) The natural or adoptive parents of the child(ren);
(3) All eligible full, half, or adoptive siblings of the child(ren).
? Excluded Persons: Individuals who cannot be included in the AU include:
(1) Undocumented noncitizens (ineligible immigrants);
(2) Individuals receiving Supplemental Security Income (SSI/SSP);
(3) Children receiving Kin-GAP, Foster Care, or Adoption Assistance;
(4) Individuals serving a CalWORKs intentional program violation (IPV) disqualification or felony fleeing felon sanction.
? Caretaker Relative Option: Non-parent caretaker relatives (such as grandparents, aunts, or uncles) with physical custody of an eligible child may choose to be included in the AU with the child or receive aid on behalf of the child only (child-only case).
? Senior Parent / Minor Parent Budgeting: When a minor parent resides with their own parents (senior parents), senior parent income deeming rules apply under EAS 44-133 unless the minor parent is legally emancipated.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Family Tree Mapping: Document household relationships, parental lineage, and sibling connections during the intake interview.

? Mandatory Member Screening: Ensure all mandatory siblings and parents residing in the home are added to the application.

? Non-Parent Choice: Formally document the caretaker relative's choice regarding whether they wish to be included in the cash grant or receive child-only assistance.